Sources



Figure 9.18 Sources of Zinc

Fish, meat, liver, egg and certain sea foods are high in zinc. Vegetable sources are cereals, pulses, yeast and wheat germ. Milk including breast milk also is a good source of zinc. The colostrum is an especially rich source.

Absorption and excretion:

Zinc present in animal foods is well absorbed in the small intestine, especially from the duodenum. Zinc present in plant foods are poorly absorbed due to the presence of phytic acid which interferes with its absorption. Zinc is mostly excreted in urine.

Deficiency

1. Zinc deficiency causes poor growth and hypogonadism during adolescence.
2. In zinc deficiency, there is poor wound healing.
3. Zinc deficiency may result in impairment of sensitivity to taste.

Unit 9.indd 246 21-05-2018 15:12:16